

Wessel Gauke Poelman

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Education

- 2023–now **PhD in Computer Science**, KU Leuven, Belgium
- *Supervisor*: Miryam de Lhoneux
 - *Topic*: Experimental Design in Multilingual NLP
 - Attended the *European Summer School in Logic, Language, and Information (ESSLLI 2023)* and the *Lisbon Machine Learning School (LxMLS 2024)*
- 2022 **MSc in Information Science**, Rijksuniversiteit Groningen, Netherlands
- *Master's thesis supervisor*: Johan Bos
 - Graduated *cum laude*, thesis results published at COLING 2022
- 2021 **BSc in Information Science**, Rijksuniversiteit Groningen, Netherlands
- 2021 **BA in Communication Sciences**, Rijksuniversiteit Groningen, Netherlands

Positions

- 2026 **Visiting Researcher**, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München (LMU), Germany
- 2023 **PhD Researcher**, Technische Universität München (TUM), Germany
- 2021–2023 **Machine Learning Engineer**, Web-IQ, Netherlands
- 2019–2021 **Software Engineer**, Beeproger, Netherlands
- 2018–2021 **Teaching, Research, and Student Assistant**, Rijksuniversiteit Groningen, Netherlands

Grants, Honors & Awards

- 2026 SAC Highlight at ACL 2026
- 2026 COST Action Short Term Scientific Mission (€3k), host: Barbara Plank (LMU)
- 2025 Danish Data Science Academy Travel Grant (€800), host: Johannes Bjerva (Aalborg University)
- 2025 Best Paper Award Nominee at EMNLP 2025
- 2025 Outstanding Reviewer (2×) ACL Rolling Review
- 2025 COST Action Travel Grant (€700)
- 2024 Outstanding Paper Award at *NLP for Conversational AI Workshop* at ACL 2024

Conference Publications

* denotes shared first authorship; ◇ denotes mentored students

- 2026 **How Good Is Your Wikipedia? Auditing Data Quality for Low-resource and Multilingual NLP**
Kushal Tatariya*, Artur Kulmizev*, **Wessel Poelman**, Esther Ploeger, Marcel Bollmann, Johannes Bjerva, Jiaming Luo, Heather Lent & Miryam de Lhoneux. In *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*. **Oral Presentation. SAC Highlight.**
- 2026 **TIPA: Typologically Informed Parameter Aggregation**
Stef Accou◇ & **Wessel Poelman**. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL 2026*.

- 2026 **Form and Meaning in Intrinsic Multilingual Evaluations**
Wessel Poelman & Miryam de Lhoneux. In *Proceedings of the 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics*. **Oral Presentation.**
- 2025 **Confounding Factors in Relating Model Performance to Morphology**
Wessel Poelman*, Thomas Bauwens* & Miryam de Lhoneux. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. **Oral Presentation.**
- 2025 **On the Interplay between Positional Encodings, Morphological Complexity, and Word Order Flexibility**
Kushal Tatariya*, Wessel Poelman* & Miryam de Lhoneux. In *Proceedings of the 14th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing and the 4th Conference of the Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics*.
- 2025 **The Roles of English in Evaluating Multilingual Language Models**
Wessel Poelman & Miryam de Lhoneux. In *Proceedings of the Joint 25th Nordic Conference on Computational Linguistics and 11th Baltic Conference on Human Language Technologies*.
- 2024 **What is “Typological Diversity” in NLP?**
Esther Ploeger*, Wessel Poelman*, Miryam de Lhoneux & Johannes Bjerva. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. **Oral Presentation.**
- 2022 **Transparent Semantic Parsing with Universal Dependencies Using Graph Transformations**
Wessel Poelman, Rik van Noord & Johan Bos. In *Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Computational Linguistics*.

Journal Publications

- 2026 **A Principled Framework for Evaluating on Typologically Diverse Languages**
Esther Ploeger, Wessel Poelman, Andreas Holck Høeg-Petersen, Anders Schlichtkrull, Miryam de Lhoneux & Johannes Bjerva. *Computational Linguistics*.
- 2024 **The CLIN33 Shared Task on the Detection of Text Generated by Large Language Models**
Pieter Fivez, Walter Daelemans, Tim Van Cruys, Yury Kashnitsky, Savvas Chamezopoulos, Hadi Mohammadi, Anastasia Giachanou, Ayoub Bagheri, Wessel Poelman, Juraj Vladika, Esther Ploeger, Johannes Bjerva, Florian Matthes & Hans Halteren. *Computational Linguistics in the Netherlands Journal*.

Workshop Publications

- 2025 **Type and Complexity Signals in Multilingual Question Representations**
Robin Kokot[◊] & Wessel Poelman. In *Proceedings of the 5th Workshop on Multilingual Representation Learning*.
- 2024 **Engineering Conversational Search Systems: A Review of Applications, Architectures, and Functional Components**
Phillip Schneider, Wessel Poelman, Michael Rovatsos & Florian Matthes. In *Proceedings of the 6th Workshop on NLP for Conversational AI*. **Outstanding Paper Award.**

- 2023 **Detecting ChatGPT: A Survey of the State of Detecting ChatGPT-Generated Text**
Mahdi Dhaini, **Wessel Poelman** & Ege Erdogan. In *Proceedings of the 8th Student Research Workshop associated with the International Conference Recent Advances in Natural Language Processing*.
- 2022 **RUG-1-Pegasussers at SemEval-2022 Task 3: Data Generation Methods to Improve Recognizing Appropriate Taxonomic Word Relations**
Frank van den Berg*, Gijs Danoe*, Esther Ploeger*, **Wessel Poelman***, Lukas Edman & Tommaso Caselli. In *Proceedings of the 16th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation*.

Research Talks

Experimental Design in Multilingual NLP

- 2026 - Centrum für Informations- und Sprachverarbeitung (CIS), LMU, Germany
- MaiNLP, LMU, Germany
- NLP Research Seminar, KU Leuven, Belgium
- 2025 - NLPnorth, IT University of Copenhagen, Denmark
- AAU-NLP, Aalborg University, Denmark
- Centre de Traitement automatique du Langage CENTAL, UCLouvain, Belgium

Teaching

- 2024–now **Natural Language Processing**, Teaching Assistant, MSc KU Leuven
- Designed assignments, taught weekly seminars, and graded exams. 150–180 students/year.
- 2024–now **Data Structures and Algorithms**, Teaching Assistant, BSc KU Leuven
- Taught weekly seminars and graded online assignments. 120–140 students/year.
- 2023 **Natural Language Processing – Methods and Applications**, Co-organizer, MSc TUM
- Organized course and supervised students with small research projects. ~40 students.
- 2022 **Workshop at LCT Summer School**, Instructor, Saarland University
- Workshop about taxonomic word relations. Together with Esther Ploeger.
- 2019 **Introduction to Programming I**, Teaching Assistant, BSc RUG
- Taught weekly seminars and assisted with exam creation.

Research Supervision

- 2026–now **Pi Hao**, MSc Data Science & Statistics at KU Leuven
- 2026–now **Sing Sing Ngai**, MSc AI at KU Leuven
- 2026 **Ran Zhang**, MSc AI at KU Leuven
- 2025 **Stef Accou**, MSc AI at KU Leuven
- Results published at EACL 2026: Findings. Winner of **EFNIL 2026 Master Thesis Award**.
- 2025 **Robin Kokot**, MSc AI at KU Leuven
- Results published at Multilingual Representation Learning Workshop.
- 2023 **Berkay Ugur Senocak**, MSc Informatics at TUM, co-supervised with Mahdi Dhaini

Service & Volunteering

2024–now	Reviewer , ACL Rolling Review (ACL, EACL, NAACL-HLT, EMNLP, AACL)
2024–now	Working Group Sub-leader , EU COST Action - <i>UniDive: Universality, Diversity, and Idiosyncrasy in Language Technology</i>
2023–now	Software Engineer , Walter Schottky Institute, TUM - Drivers and parameter sweeps for measurements in experimental physics lab.
2025	Program Chair , 2nd UniDive Training School on <i>Quantifying Linguistic Diversity</i>
2025–2026	Guest Editor , <i>Computational Linguistics in the Netherlands</i> Journal
2025	Co-organizer , 35th edition of <i>Computational Linguistics in the Netherlands</i> Conference

Software

QQ. Toolkit for language identifiers and metadata ([GitHub](#) & [Browser Explorer](#)).

Planit. Tooling for SLURM-based research workflows ([GitHub](#)).

Typdiv Sampling. Toolkit for language sampling and analysis ([GitHub](#)).

Languages

Dutch (native), West-Frisian (native speaker), English (fluent), German (B1.1, following courses)